Prior to the establishment of the State of Israel, the Shai, the Haganah's intelligence service, was active in cyber intelligence. Among other things, the Shai succeeded in tapping into the British Mandate's central telephone switchboard in Jaffa. According to Shai sources, "Tapping the telephone lines allowed us to listen to the conversations of British government officials and Arab leaders day and night."[2]

In the 1940s and '50s, the peak of the intelligence war between Israel and the Arab countries was the recruitment and operation of agents (HUMINT), immediately followed by "tongue catching," operations not using technology, but whose intelligence product was of very high quality. The objective of these operations was to capture a military officer beyond Israel's border with an Arab country, bring him to Israel, and reap the intelligence that was stored inside his head.

The first cyber operation to which the Israeli public was exposed (because of a mishap) took place in 1954. The mission was to service a warning device on the Syrian Golan Heights, near the international border. The team consisted of five soldiers, who were captured by the Syrians when they crossed the border. One of them, Uri Ilan, committed suicide during his captivity, leaving a note attached to his foot with the words "I did not betray."[3]

Alongside the cyber intelligence technique of tapping communication lines, additional technologies were developed in the field of electronics.

What we know about the capabilities of the superpowers in this area during the Cold War is no less interesting and highlights the gap between the capabilities of the superpowers and those of the "regular" developed countries. The superpowers were able to drop tiny, camouflaged audio-surveillance systems from reconnaissance aircraft, flying at high altitudes near enemy installations, that would intercept information and transmit it to intelligence satellites. The superpowers also knew how to physically connect to communications cables deep in the ocean or at the points at which they met land.

In the 1990s, the cyber world took things up a notch. Technological capabilities developed that could achieve all of these things but control them remotely, at a standoff distance, and without physical contact.

Cyber warfare is a constant war between the attacker and the defender, with each side developing capabilities in both areas—defense and attack—in parallel. The war is between those whose job it is to protect national